

Plankton bloom

Summer sunlight melts some of the sea ice, allowing tiny sea life to develop. In polar regions, small plants called phytoplankton grow rapidly, which causes a bloom. This bloom provides a much-needed source of food for marine life.



This satellite image shows an enormous phytoplankton bloom.



Frozen food

The Southern Ocean is home to a huge amount of Antarctic krill. These small animals are at the heart of the marine food chain. Krill feed on phytoplankton, but they are eaten by whales, seals, and penguins.